

Hedera Hello Future: Ascension Hackathon 2025 Rules

Unless otherwise defined, all capitalised terms used herein shall bear the same meanings as in the [Hackathon Terms of Service](#).

1. The Hackathon

1.1 These Hackathon Rules apply to the **Hedera Hello Future: Ascension Hackathon 2025** (the “Hackathon”).

1.2 The Hackathon is a virtual hackathon taking place from **3 November 2025** to **21 November 2025**.

1.3 **Age Restrictions:** Participants must be at least **18 years of age**.

1.4 **Geographical Restrictions:** This hackathon is open only to legal and eligible residents of countries across the Globe with the exception of the following countries and locations:

- People’s Republic of China
- Russia
- Cuba
- Iran
- North Korea
- Syria
- Specific regions of Ukraine: *Crimea, Donetsk, and Luhansk
- Afghanistan
- Belarus
- Burma (Myanmar)
- Central African Republic
- Democratic Republic of the Congo
- Ethiopia
- Hong Kong
- Iraq
- Lebanon
- Libya
- Nicaragua
- Somalia
- South Sudan
- Sudan
- Venezuela
- Yemen

1.5 **Background Restrictions:** Employees of Hedera and Hashgraph are not eligible to participate or qualify for prizes listed on this hackathon.

2. Teams

2.1 Participants are to form only **one (1)** Hackathon Team and each Hackathon Team must consist of at least **one (1)** member and shall not exceed **five (5)** members.

2.2 Each Hackathon Team shall appoint one (1) Participant as the Hackathon Team’s representative.

2.3 The Hackathon Team’s representative is to submit the list of members in their Hackathon Team to AngelHack, by such date as may be required by AngelHack.

3. Participants’ Code of Conduct

- 3.1 The Participants consist of people from countries around the world and we expect all Participants to respect the diversity of our community. Content containing illegal or excessive obscene or foul language, excessive violence, nudity, or sexual activity will be flagged and removed. Content that is abusive or likely to be offensive to others may also be flagged and removed.
- 3.2 As the Hackathon is an ongoing process over a period of time, Hackathon Participants, AngelHack and the Organising Partner(s) may not be as responsive as you may hope for, due to reasons such as, amongst others, time zone differences, personal commitments outside the Hackathon, and work or education commitments. Therefore, we seek understanding from all involved parties in the Hackathon to respect each individual's boundaries, external commitments or circumstances. Acts of disrespect to Participants, AngelHack, or the Organising Partner(s), includes, but is not limited to, constant messaging within an unreasonably short period of time, flooding the Hackathon main channel(s) without providing a reasonable amount of time for responses to be made, use of abusive and/or demanding language, etc.
- 3.3 We value integrity and expect you to represent who you are and your Hackathon Team honestly in your submissions and in any forms that we share with you during the course of the Hackathon.
- 3.4 We celebrate makers, creators, developers and want to help each of you who are part of this community grow and improve your skills. When you share feedback, please keep it constructive. Any content that is abusive, threatening, expresses hatred, or is likely to offend others is unacceptable and may result in the content being removed, the suspension or termination of your account, or disqualification from the Hackathon, at the sole discretion of AngelHack and/or the Organising Partner(s).
- 3.5 Do not share or post any personal or private information about you or any other person. This includes any photos (unless you have explicit permission to do so), phone numbers, addresses, location details, personal email, social media profiles.
- 3.6 Our community and platforms help showcase software, participate in virtual challenges and hackathons, share your ideas, code, get feedback and motivation. Do not upload anything unrelated, explicit, repeatedly post the same thing or post anything that is not relevant to the event that you are participating in or send excessive, unsolicited messages to other users.

4. Project Rules

- 4.1 The hacking period and Submission Period for the Hackathon shall be from **3 November 2025, 10am ET to 21 November 2025, 11:59pm ET**.
- 4.2 The Hackathon Team's representative must submit the Team's Submission to the Hackathon's submission portal during the official Submission Period. You and your Hackathon Team are only allowed to make **one (1)** submission for **one (1)** main track.
- 4.3 You and your Hackathon Team are strictly not allowed to submit Submissions that are not created by you or that are not what you have worked on during the period of the Hackathon. If there are other projects that could be great resources, kindly reach out to AngelHack or the Organising Partner(s) in the community and request to add such projects to the resources.
- 4.4 You and your Hackathon Team are not allowed to work on your project before the hacking period stipulated in Rule 4.1. Each team is required to use version control for your code throughout the course of the Hackathon. Any repositories with single commits of large files without proper history will be default assumed to be unqualified unless proven otherwise.
- 4.5 Each Submission will be judged solely on what you and your Hackathon team has worked on during the duration of the Hackathon. Each team is required to share the source code of the Submission on the Submission Portal.

- 4.6 If you or your Hackathon Team are using an existing project, you must credit the project by disclosing all details of the same and outline the improvements made to the project in your Submission, provided always that the Intellectual Property Rights of such existing project is exclusively owned by you or a member of your Hackathon Team. Participants who wish to continue working on a project from the past Hedera Hackathons must submit their project under the Legacy Builders track. Failure to comply with this Rule 4.6 may result in the disqualification of you and your Hackathon Team and the team's Submission.
- 4.7 If someone has helped you or contributed to your Submission, you must credit them in your Submission for their contribution.
- 4.8 Make sure to check the license of any public repository before you use it for your Submission and give the appropriate credit to that repository and the creator in your Submission. You cannot utilize content that violates any third party's rights (including privacy, personality, moral or intellectual property rights, or that constitutes copyright infringement) unless you have acquired the necessary rights to do so or the content is subject to an open source license.
- 4.9 When making your Hackathon Submission, you must ensure that your Submission adheres to the Fresh Code Rule (as defined below) or that you have the right to use any existing content that forms the whole or a part of your Submission. This includes, without limitation, images, lines of code or demonstration videos in your Submission.
- 4.10 You must ensure that you have the permission from all persons, venues and/or entities who worked on or were engaged to work on or contributed in any respect to the Submission or any part thereof. Otherwise, please do not use such material and do not upload the same in your Submission.

5. The Fresh Code Rule

- 5.1 All Hackathon Teams should strictly adhere to the fresh code rule, under which the following should be adhered to (the "**Fresh Code Rule**"):

5.1.1 What can be done **before** the Hackathon

- (a) Hackathon Teams can create wireframes, designs and user flow.
- (b) Hackathon Teams can pre-train models or gather data sets prior to the event.

5.1.2 What must be done **during** the Hackathon

- (a) All code submitted as part of the Submission must be written during the Hackathon and submitted before the expiry of the Submission Period (as per Rule 4.1).
- 5.2 Provided that the Fresh Code Rule is adhered to, Participants and/or their Hackathon Team are allowed to use any coding languages or open-source libraries as part of their Submission.

6. Cross-chain Compatibility

- 6.1 Hackathon Teams are permitted to create their Submission by utilising cross-chain compatibility, provided always that such technology must be utilised in the creation of or the development of any existing lines of code in such Submission.
- 6.2 Failure to comply with Rule 6.1 may result in disqualification from the Hackathon, provided always that such disqualification shall be at the sole discretion of AngelHack.

7. Intellectual Property Rights

Save as otherwise agreed with the relevant Hackathon Team (including under these Hackathon Rules and the AngelHack Terms of Service), all Intellectual Property Rights subsisting in a Hackathon Team's Submission shall remain vested in such Hackathon Team.

7.1 To the extent permitted by applicable law, the User (whether as Partner, Participant or otherwise) hereby irrevocably accepts and grants to AngelHack and/or Organising Partner(s) a royalty-free, sub-licensable, transferable, perpetual, irrevocable, non-exclusive, worldwide license to use, reproduce, modify, publish, list information regarding, edit, translate, distribute, publicly perform, publicly display, and make derivative works of all Submissions (including pre-hackathon resources) for the following purposes:

- (a) providing the Services to the User;
- (b) reviewing of submitted content, for compliance against our Terms;
- (c) reviewing of submitted content, for compliance with applicable law;
- (d) promotional, marketing and advertising purposes;
- (e) backup and archival purposes; and
- (f) research and generation of reports.

8. Prizes

8.1 The prizes for the Hackathon are denominated in USDC, and includes all applicable taxes and fees associated with prize receipt and/or use by the prize recipients. Prize recipients will be required to provide the necessary payment and/or distribution details requested by AngelHack and/or Organising Partner(s) in a timely and accurate fashion in order to receive the relevant prize.

8.1.1 All prize recipients will be contacted within thirty (30) working days after the announcement of the Winner(s) and prize administration will take place within the next sixty (60) working days after the Hackathon has concluded.

8.1.2 Prizes for the Hackathon shall be distributed and administered in the manner determined by AngelHack and/or Organising Partner(s) in its sole discretion.

8.2 Prize distribution may be delayed due to processing time or where there are any issues with the information provided by a recipient of a prize. For example, distribution of a prize in fiat currency may be delayed by an additional fourteen (14) days to account for further processing time for the following cases:

- (a) Winning team and/or its members are based in a country where the cryptocurrency wallet does not operate, where the relevant cryptocurrency is restricted or illegal in such country, or where the cryptocurrency platform has issues receiving the transfer.
- (b) Correction of bank information or cryptocurrency wallet information provided by the winning teams.
- (c) Requests to facilitate local bank's funds verification process and processing timeline.

8.3 You agree that AngelHack and/or Organising Partner(s) shall be deemed to have discharged its obligations in relation to the administration and distribution of prizes under this Rule 8 upon effecting the administration and distribution of such prizes in accordance with the relevant

details provided by the relevant Winners under Rule 8.2. Save in the case of fraud, gross negligence or misconduct, AngelHack and/or the Organising Partner(s) shall not be responsible for any delay and/or failure to receive the prizes.

9. Removal of Content and Terms

AngelHack and/or Organising Partner(s) reserves the right to remove your content and/or block or remove your account from the platform if we believe that you have violated any of the guidelines mentioned above.

10. Incorporation of General Terms

In addition to these Hackathon Rules, please read our [terms of service](#), [privacy policy](#), [code of conduct](#) for terms which also apply to your participation in the Hackathon.

AngelHack and/or the Organising Partner(s) reserve the right to modify these Hackathon Rules without prior notice.